PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #38 · DEPRESSION

“I’ll never get over this.”

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Where it often comes from

Some wounds are so large that “getting over it” sounds like an insult. A death, a betrayal, an illness, a public shame, or a depression that has lasted for years can make recovery seem like a fairy tale. The hurt is real, and it may leave a mark. The lie is the word “never”: the claim that comfort, strength, and a life that is more than this pain are permanently impossible. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 in the United States, or tell someone near you right away.

What Scripture teaches

God does not tell wounded people to pretend they were never hurt. He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds. He is the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles. Weeping may stay the night, and joy comes in the morning. Mercies are new every morning. These promises do not mean the loss was small or that grief has a deadline. They mean the pain does not get to say “forever.”

> *“He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds”* (Psalm 147:3).

Also see

> “Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves have received from God” (2 Corinthians 1:3–4).

> “For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning” (Psalm 30:5).

> “Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!” (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> “And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose” (Romans 8:28).

Common self-statements

- This will always feel exactly like it does today.
- If I were going to heal, I would have by now.
- People who say it gets better do not understand.
- I am not allowed to feel any relief.
- My life stopped, and it cannot start again.
- Comfort is for milder problems than mine.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Declaring that healing can never begin.
- All-or-nothing thinking: If I am not completely over it, I am not healing at all.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling raw today and concluding I always will.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring any hour that hurt a little less.

Challenging questions

- What would “a little better” look like, short of forgetting?
- Has any part of this already become more bearable than it was at first?
- Am I asking myself to be finished, when God is asking me to be comforted?
- Who has walked with someone through a pain that once seemed final?
- What comfort has God already given, even if the loss remains?
- What is one kindness I can receive this week while I am still hurting?

Truth summary

> I may not be over this today, and that does not mean I never will. God comforts me, and healing can come one day at a time.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

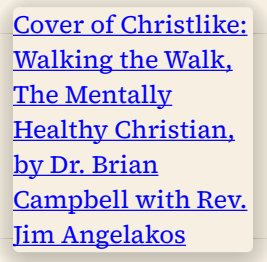
- Sorrow
- Suffering
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Hopeless
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Depression
- Suffering
- Thinking, Healthy

What does a mentally healthy Christian look like?



From *Christlike: Walking the Walk* by Dr. Brian Campbell. A portrait, verse by verse, of how a mentally healthy Christian thinks, feels, and lives.

Read excerpts from “The Mentally Healthy Christian” (with every Scripture written out)

Listen: Overcoming Depression

Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God makes things new. The present pain is not His last word.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection is a hope beyond what feels permanent.

Hymn of Heaven — Phil Wickham
Christian hope looks past this wound to a restored life with God.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
You belong to Christ. This pain is not your only story.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, what is one step I could take today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll never get over this."

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll never get over this." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What would "a little better" look like, short of forgetting?
- ☐ Has any part of this already become more bearable than it was at first?
- ☐ Am I asking myself to be finished, when God is asking me to be comforted?
- ☐ Who has walked with someone through a pain that once seemed final?
- ☐ What comfort has God already given, even if the loss remains?
- ☐ What is one kindness I can receive this week while I am still hurting?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I may not be over this today, and that does not mean I never will. God comforts me, and healing can come one day at a time.
- ☐ Not being over it today is not the same as never healing.
- ☐ God comforts me inside the trouble, not only after it.
- ☐ I can hurt and still be held.
- ☐ A smaller pain than yesterday can count as mercy.
- ☐ I do not have to heal on someone else's schedule.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 147:3
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 1:3–4
  "Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort, who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves have received from God."
- ☐ Psalm 30:5
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When the "I'll never get over this" feeling came: Each day, write down one moment when healing felt impossible. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 147:3 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God heals the brokenhearted. I am not finished, and I am not abandoned in this.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Sorrow" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio or the Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Mark one smaller moment. Each day, note one minute that hurt less, or one comfort you received. "Never" has to argue with that note.
- [ ] Let someone sit with you. Tell one safe person you are not over it, and let them stay. You do not have to perform recovery.
- [ ] Receive one comfort on purpose. A meal, a walk, a prayer, or a song. Write what you received.
- [ ] Get help if "never" includes wanting to die. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988, or tell someone near you today.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll never get over this.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment of comfort
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll never get over this~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I cannot see a way past this pain. Be the God of comfort here, not only later. Heal what I cannot rush, and keep me from calling this the end. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.